



/ LA PETITE MORT / 2022

CATALOG 2022 #006



Raghava

RAGHAVA KK

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La Petite Mort

Created by Raghava KK 2022

The regeneration project is deeply appealing to me because it talks about a fundamental and urgent need for change in human behavior and it's attitude towards our planet and all things living.

The biggest problem humanity is facing is the apathy and behavior of humans towards our planet and life in general. One part of the problem stems from our behavior patterns, however, there is a far more fundamental problem than that, which is the belief systems that we hold.

As an artist, one can do two things. One can direct humans towards solutions, and one can simultaneously raise their consciousness to make them aware of the conflicts that they are dealing with. I'm interested in working on disrupting the beliefs of people. A belief for me is a combination of thought and attitude.

*How does one modify the belief of somebody?
Could you do that through a sacred encounter with art?*

An encounter with La Petite Mort begs the question: Should we as a people digitize and productize everything, now that that is possible? And if so, should the most intimate of human experiences also be a product?

Desire is the perfect metaphor for the regeneration project because, in Sanskrit, the word for life is Jiva which literally means hunger. If life is at the center of everything, as the regeneration project claims, then desire could be an Indian perspective on life. I'm documenting and productizing elements of human experience that are considered the most valuable because they're directly related to being alive.

I choose La Petit Mort as my regeneration project, because I want to regenerate belief itself. What does it mean for a belief to manifest itself differently? So what are the beliefs we're talking about? Belief in that there is a fundamental problem between our desire for consumption and the need to feel alive. On one hand, if we don't productize our experiences we can't even share them. We can't even partake in them or trade them to create cultures. productizing an experience makes the experience permanent and therefore starts creating systems around it. Which then again, chokes up the possibility of regeneration.

Regeneration is going back with new belief systems, back to fundamentals with a completely fresh self. And I believe that an encounter with this work is going to reset your thinking because it makes obvious the most blatant ethical conflict that few of us see. How much consumption and commodification is enough for us to feel alive together? What do we gain, lose in the process? How does this attempt itself change the experience of being alive together?

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The Machine desires - I

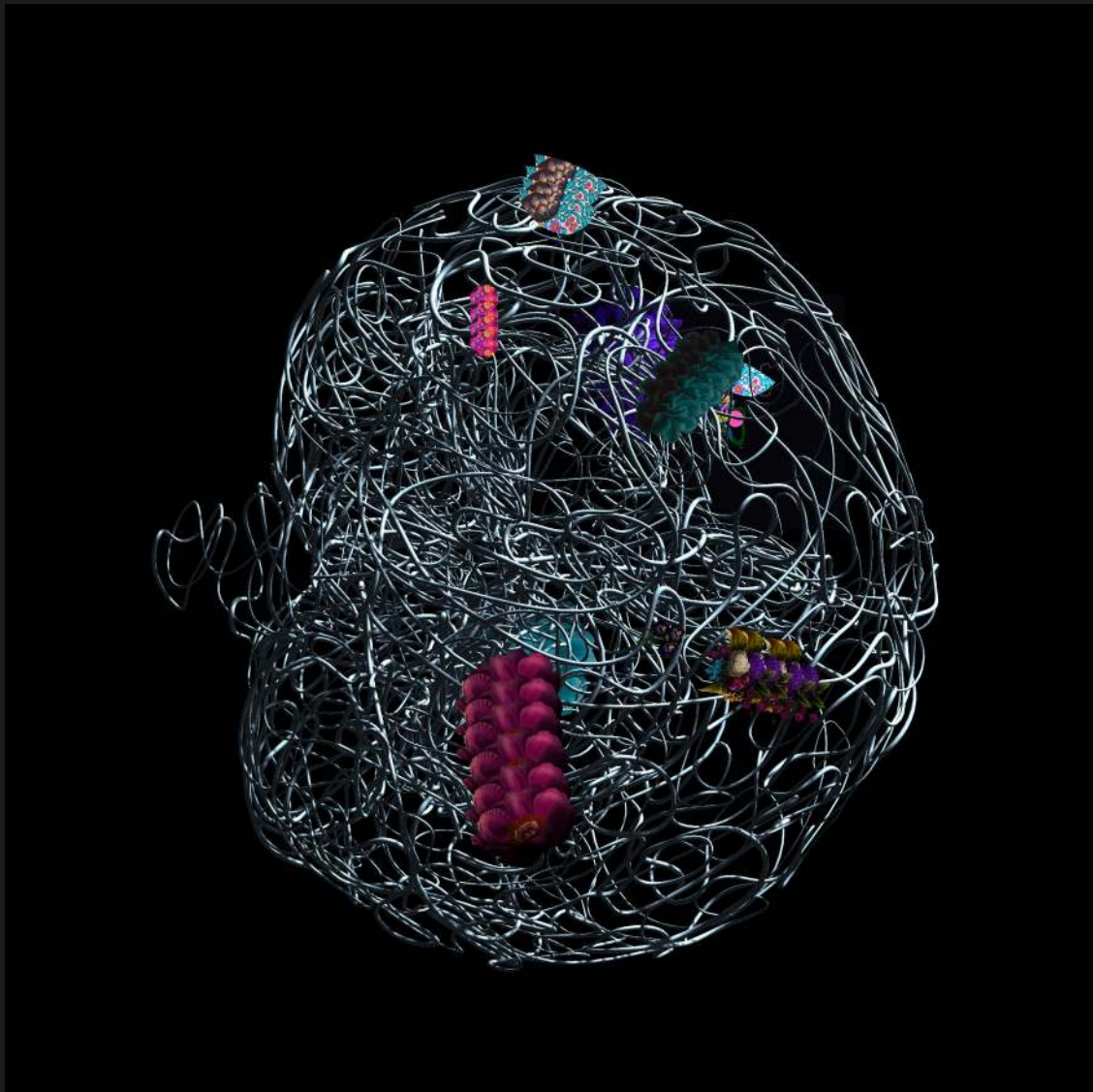
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2022
Raghava KK
Editions: 250
Price: \$20 per edition



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The Machine desires - II

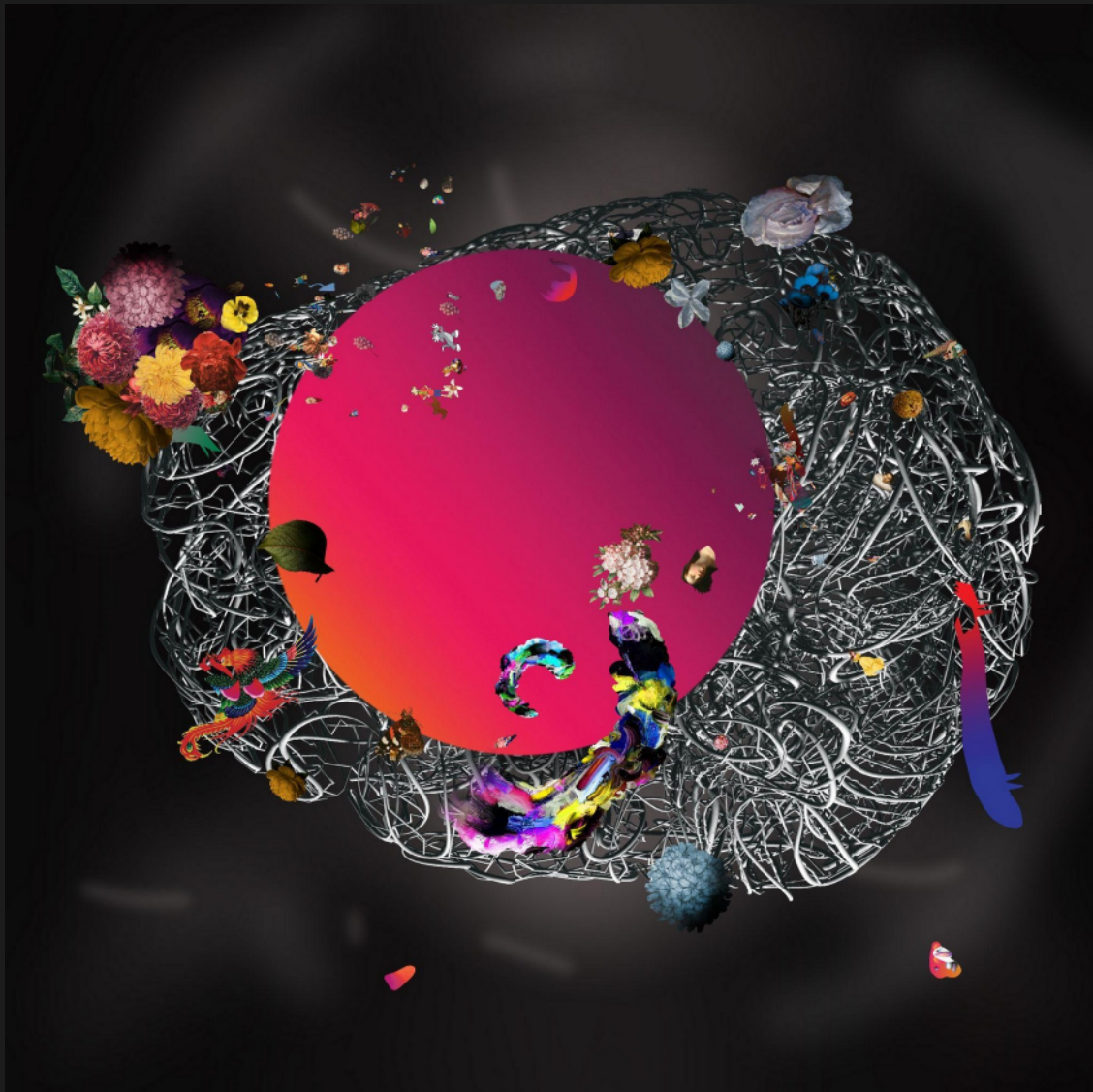
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The Machine desires - III

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The Machine desires - IV

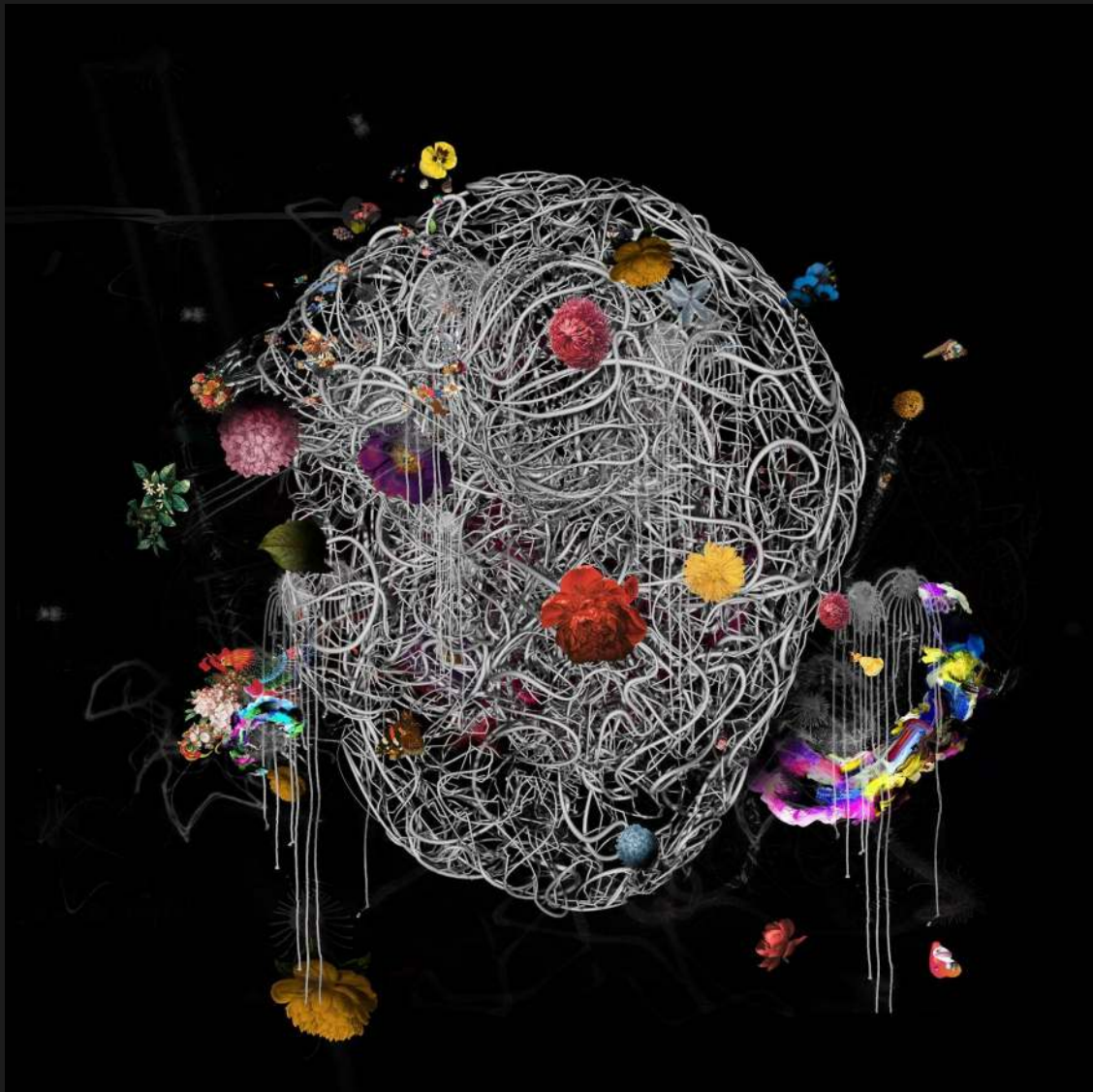
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The Machine desires - V

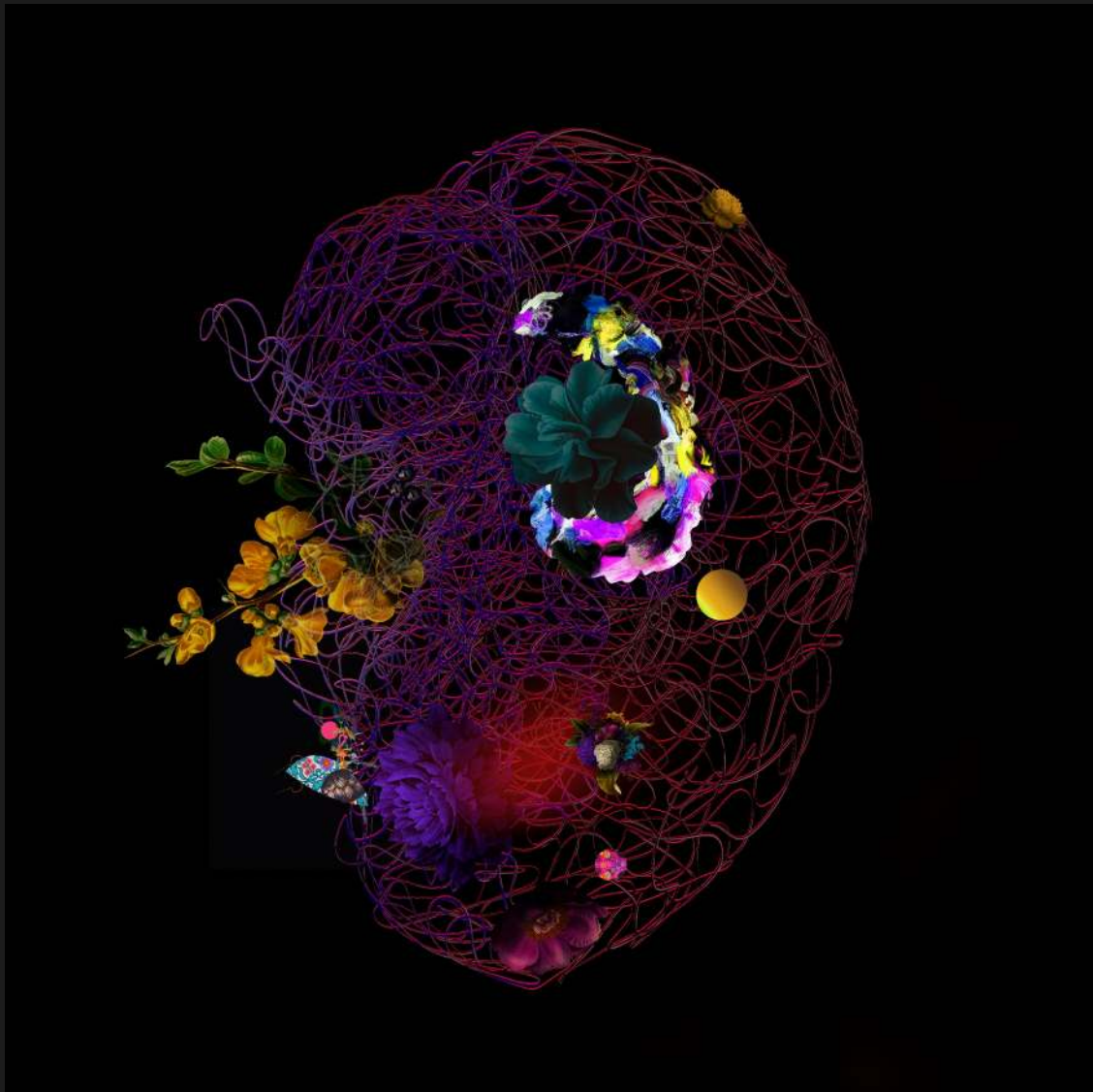
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The Machine desires - VI

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Editions: 250
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The Machine desires - VII

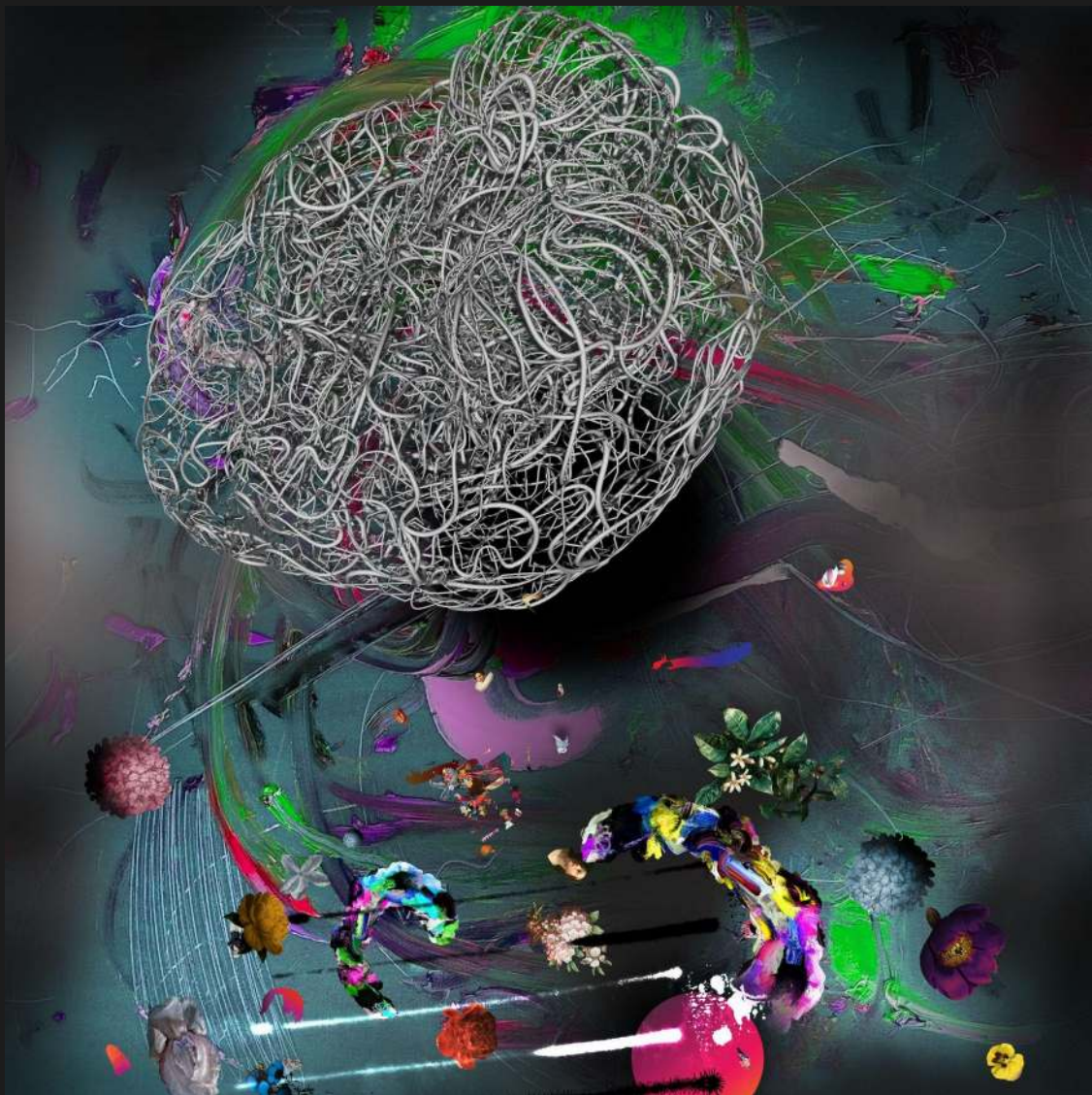
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The Machine desires - X

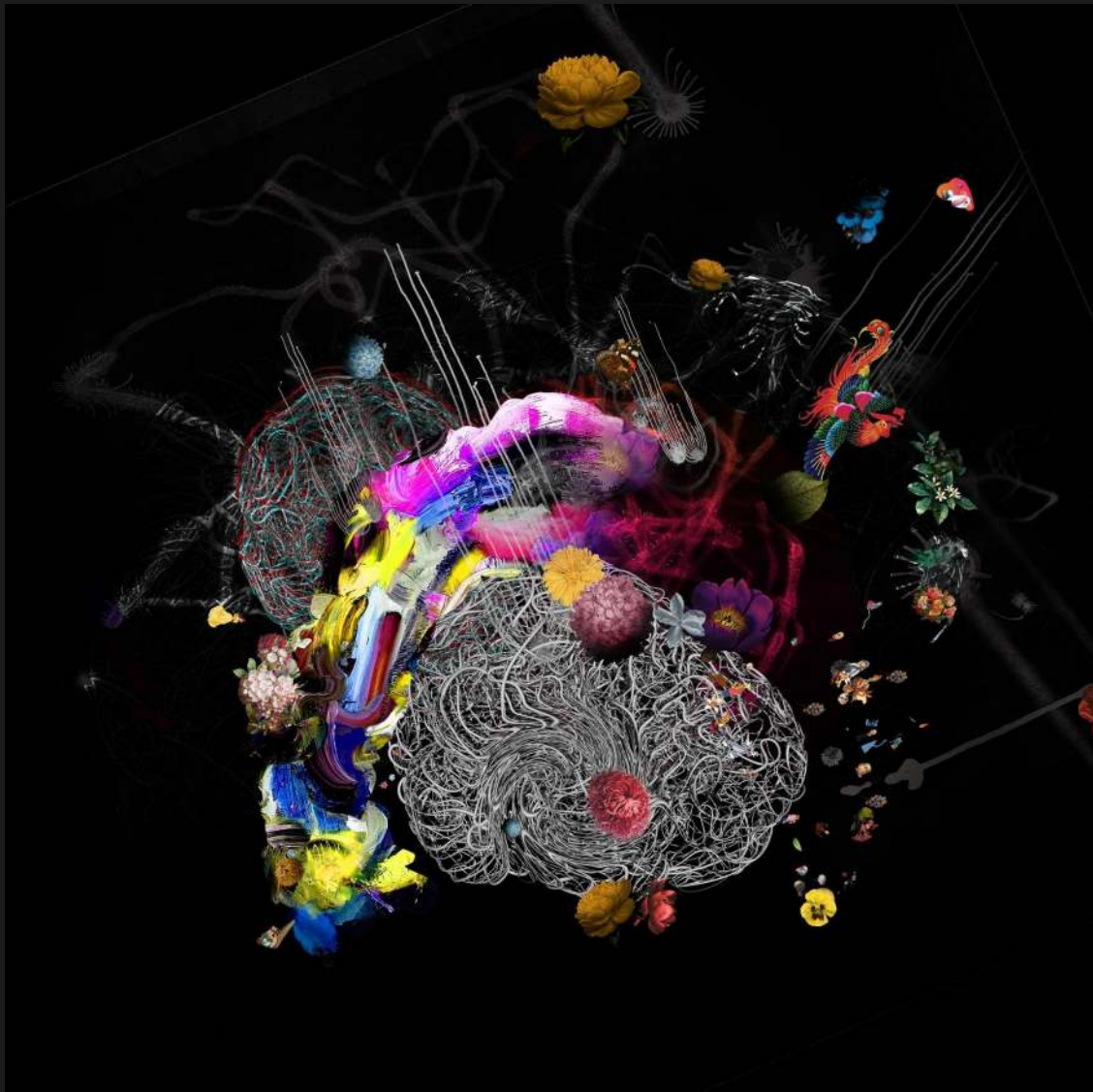
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The Machine desires - VIII

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Editions: 250
Price: \$20 per edition



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The Machine desires - IX

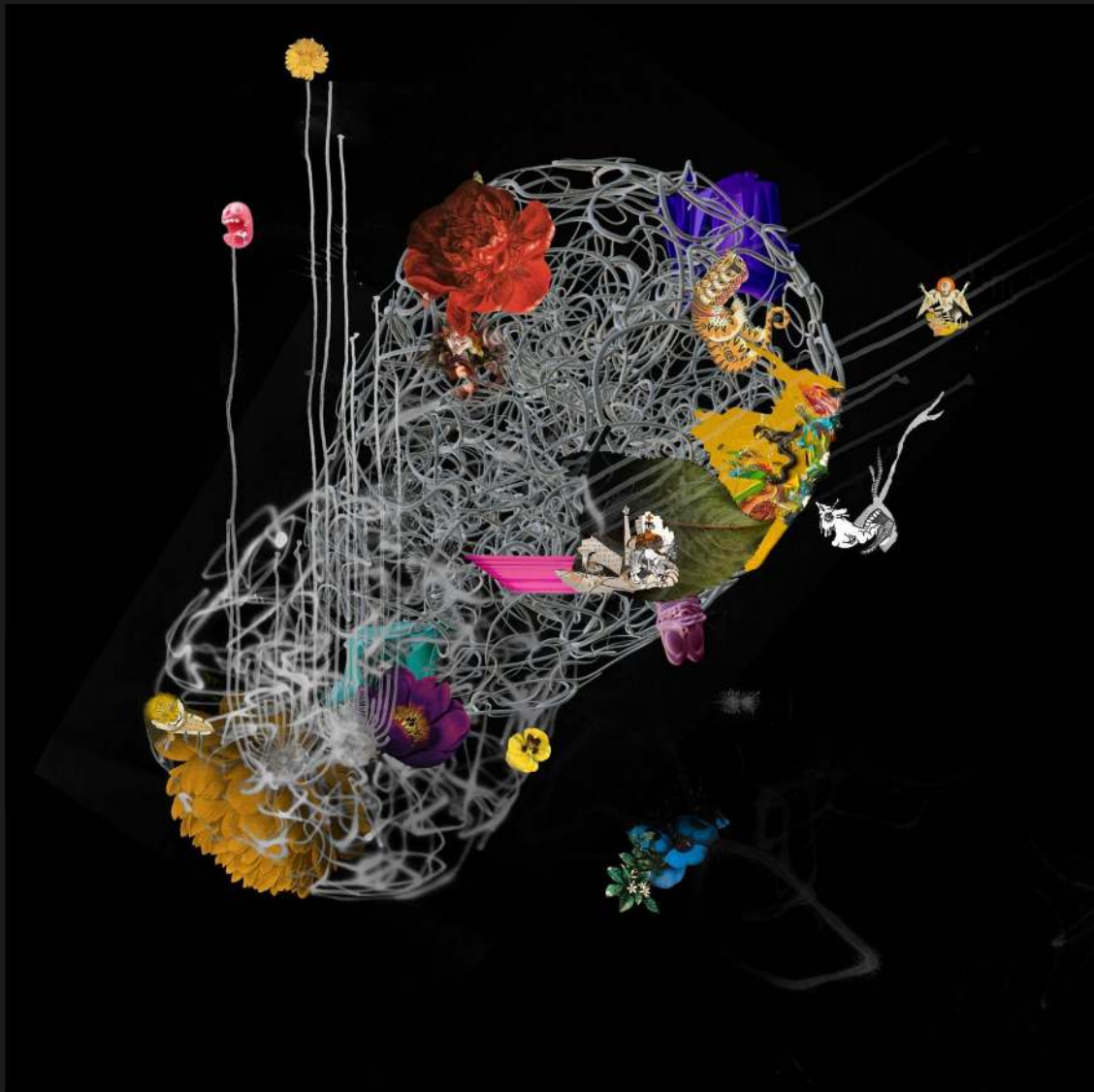
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The Machine desires - X

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Raghava KK

2022

Raghava KK has pioneered a groundbreaking body of diverse works that explore transcendence through the lens of the current digital era. Featured on CNN's list of ten fascinating thinkers, authors and provocateurs in 2010, Raghava's work traverses traditional forms of painting, installation and performance, while his practice embraces new media (artificial intelligence, neuro-feedback, biohacking, board and video games, crypto currencies etc), to express post-human contemporary realities. His lectures, including 5 TED talks, are known for inspiring audiences to expand their social and psychological selves, using art. Last year, Netflix launched an episode on Raghava in the Creative Indians Series.

Raghava's storytelling migrates among his various disciplines through 50 foot live paintings, interactive books on Apple's iPad (Pop-it, won a Kirkus book award and won best of Singapore Art Fair that year), music inspired art for Erykah Badu and Paul Simon, as creator in residence at Viacom, NY, Raghava premiered Must# at both TED and Viacom HQ, A Visual Empathy Algorithm that learned how the viewer made meaning visually and pushed him to transcend the limits of his taste.

Raghava has mentored several creative entrepreneurs by infusing his philosophy into their processes and products. In 2010, Raghava co-founded and chaired The INK Fellowship (The TED of India), India's leading global multidisciplinary fellowship program. Raghava was inducted into the National Geographic Society in 2013 as an Explorer, for pushing the boundaries of scientific exploration through art.

In 2015, he created a new compositional process, part human and part algorithm-driven through his collaborative project SOZO - a painting machine, developed for him by Artmatr, an offshoot of the MIT Media lab.

In 2017, Raghava was invited by Jeff Bezos to conduct an art workshop for leading creative minds from around the world. The same year, as a partner, he helped set up the vision and strategy for India's largest venture fund for wellbeing.

In 2018, Raghava co-founded 64/1, an art collective dedicated to blurring the lines between art, art criticism and art education.

In 2020, Raghava created Eye Candy - a performance art piece on Instagram (with Under25 studios) in an attempt to reach out to a completely different audience, than the usual one for high art, through a completely different art form that combines monologue, painting and self-help.

In 2021, Raghava was the first Indian to launch an NFT at Sotheby's, New York in partnership with BurningMan - a collaborative artwork created using brainwaves, AI and painting robots at Boundless Space. Raghava also worked on a collaborative AI art piece created with Harshit Agrawal and 64/1 (Karthik Kalyanaraman and Raghava KK - an art collective dedicated to blurring the lines between art, art criticism and art education) called Strange Genders was exhibited at Exostential - an AI art show at Emami Art Foundation, Kolkata. The artwork has currently been longlisted for the Lumen Prize 2021.

He currently lives and works out of New York and Bangalore, India.